

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Lemon Ricotta Ravioli

A bright, creamy and very easy pasta dish. Good lemon ricotta ravioli are enough; all the emotion of the recipe is in the sauce: onions, garlic, butter, fresh lemon, acidic white wine, cream, chicken broth and a tiny spoon of mild curry.

Serves	Prep	Cook	Style
2-3	10 min	20 min	Creamy lemon comfort

TheFAB studio note

Use a good product for the ravioli, then make the sauce feel personal. The lemon brings the light, the cream brings comfort, and the little touch of curry gives warmth without turning the dish into a curry dish.

Ingredients

- 500 g good-quality lemon ricotta ravioli, fresh if possible
- 2 onions, finely sliced or chopped
- 2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 50-70 g fresh butter
- Juice of 1 organic lemon, plus a little zest if you want more perfume
- 120 ml good acidic dry white wine
- 150-200 ml fresh cream
- 100-150 ml good chicken broth
- 1 small spoon of mild curry powder
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper
- Optional finish: a little grated Parmesan, lemon zest or fresh parsley

Method

- 1 Melt the butter in a large pan over gentle heat. Add the onions and let them cook slowly until soft and sweet, without rushing them.
- 2 Add the garlic and continue cooking for a minute or two. It should become fragrant but should not burn.
- 3 Pour in the lemon juice and the white wine. Let it bubble gently so the alcohol evaporates and the acidity becomes rounder.
- 4 Add the cream, chicken broth, pepper, salt and the small spoon of mild curry. Stir well and let the sauce reduce slowly until the texture becomes creamy and coats the back of a spoon.

- 5
- Cook the lemon ricotta ravioli al dente in salted water. Drain carefully, add them to the pan, and toss very gently in the sauce. Serve immediately, with a little lemon zest or Parmesan if desired.

Proposed wine pairing

This dish needs freshness first: the sauce is creamy, but the lemon and white wine want a wine with clean acidity and no heavy oak.

Best match	A crisp Italian white such as Vermentino, Soave Classico, Etna Bianco or Verdicchio.
Also works	Sancerre, Pouilly-Fume, Chablis, dry Riesling or an elegant Sauvignon Blanc with citrus tension.
For richer moments	A restrained white Burgundy or a lightly creamy Chardonnay can work if it keeps enough acidity.
For red lovers	Only a very light red, served slightly cool: Pinot Noir, Bardolino or young Valpolicella. Avoid tannins.
Why it works	The acidity lifts the cream and echoes the lemon, while the herbal and mineral notes keep the mild curry and ricotta from feeling heavy.
Serving note	Use the same style of wine in the sauce and in the glass: dry, fresh, acidic and clean. The wine should sharpen the dish, not dominate it.

Personal adjustment: reduce the sauce slowly and taste before serving. With a few ingredients, the final balance is everything: enough lemon to be alive, enough cream to be comforting, and just enough curry to make people wonder what makes it so good.